Microsoft 365

Recommended Prompts for Microsoft 365 Copilot

Discover what sets Copilot apart

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Getting Started

This guide is your quick path to **harnessing the power of Microsoft 365 Copilot,** your AI assistant built for work. Inside, you will discover **practical, high-impact prompts** to help transform your workflow, highlighting the unique features that set Microsoft 365 Copilot apart from other AI tools.

Explore prompts today to see how Microsoft 365 Copilot can work for you.

1. Use **Work toggle** for prompts using your company's data and **Web toggle** for general internet-based questions.
2. **Evaluate the responses** using the ACRUE rubric to ensure quality.
3. **Share your favorite prompts and helpful tips** to support your team's success.
4. **Provide feedback** to your admin or through Copilot's tools to help improve your experience.

Always remember to:

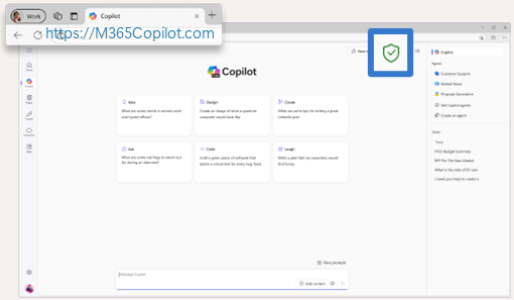
- **Review and verify AI-generated responses.** Copilot uses Large Language Models (LLMs), advanced systems designed to predict and generate text. Occasionally, responses may contain inaccuracies due to the complex nature of LLMs. Always evaluate Copilot's output and cross-check with trusted sources as needed.
- **Using the same prompt multiple times may yield different responses.** LLMs rely on neural networks, which can introduce some variability. Even with identical prompts, responses might vary slightly each time.
- **Use Copilot responsibly, ethically, and legally.** Avoid employing Copilot for any activities that could harm yourself or others. For more information, see our responsible AI (Artificial Intelligence) principles and standards.

Microsoft 365 Copilot

Prompts to try for Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat

To get started, tap **Work toggle** in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app or visit https://www.M365copilot.com. Then, launch Copilot in your Microsoft 365 apps—on web or desktop—to access the full range of capabilities tailored to your prompt. **To unlock even more potential, Try GPT-5.**

⚠ Important: If you are not signed in with your work account, Enterprise Data Protection does not apply.



Scenario	Prompt
Prepare for meetings	Create a 360-degree overview of [project or customer name] for an upcoming meeting based on recent emails, meetings, status report, and recent company news. Share recommendations for the meeting and potential questions I should ask.
Recap missed meetings	I was out last week. Fill me in on the meetings from [/meeting series] that I missed. Organize by open and resolved issues. Specify who resolved the issue.
Send a follow-up email	Draft a follow-up email based on the action items from the recent meeting [/meeting series].
Summarize key documents	Please summarize the [/document] and include any key details I should know to help me prepare for my upcoming meeting.
Summarize unread messages	Summarize my unread messages from my manager and skip manager. Categorize by project.
Organize your priorities	Identify all tasks or action items assigned to me in this week's emails, Teams chats, and meeting notes, and compile them into a checklist.
Track unresolved issues	What are the unresolved issues from prior meetings of [/meeting series].
Combine key insights	Synthesize key information across the different documents on [topic] in [/SharePoint site].
Get insights into your organization	I'm headed to a meeting with [/name] to start a new cross-team collaboration. Provide a detailed organizational chart showing his manager, skip manager, and their direct reports.
Create research reports	Based on the internal meeting discussion on [topic], draft a comprehensive research report evaluating the ideas proposed. Incorporate relevant insights from external market research, customer meetings and internal intelligence.

Prompts to try for Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat in Microsoft 365 apps

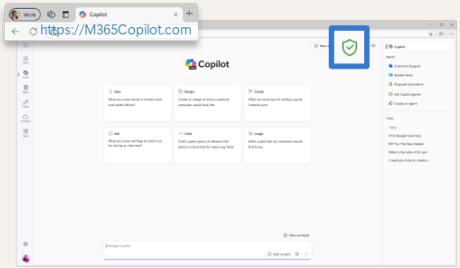
Scenario	Copilot in...	Prompt
Summarize key discussions	Outlook	Write a recap email for my team based on the discussion in this email thread.
Stay on top of meetings	Teams meeting	Summarize what's been discussed so far and list any open questions or unresolved items.
Jumpstart an email based on a meeting	Teams meeting	Draft a follow-up email based on the action items from today's meeting [/meeting].
Create precise questions	Teams meeting	Create a list of follow-up questions from the [/meeting]
Recap action items	Teams meeting	Recap the meeting before I joined and list any action items where I was mentioned.
Draft a document	Word	Create an intro paragraph with [/file]
Visualize data	Excel	Share the top insights and trends of this data and create a visualization
Create speaker notes	PowerPoint	Create speaker notes for this slide. Write them in bullets and be sure to add context on our differentiation with this strategy document.

Secure Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat

Prompts to try for Copilot Chat

To get started, tap **Web toggle** in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app or visit https://www.M365copilot.com.**To unlock even more potential in Copilot, Try GPT-5.**

⚠ Important: If you are not signed in with your work account, Enterprise Data Protection does not apply.



Scenario	Prompt
Develop a project plan	Review the attached project plan and give me five substantive ways to make it better; include rationale for your responses and specific text to insert into the plan.
Prepare an executive report	Use the attached spreadsheet with customer feedback to create a polished executive report that helps upper management decide where to prioritize resources in our next cycle. [upload file]
Improve a document draft	We have a draft press release [document]. Find a couple of similar recent announcements on the web and then suggest how to make ours stand out
Gain subject-matter knowledge	Act as a financial compliance analyst, prepare a summary comparing the Dodd-Frank, Basel III, and MiFID II capital adequacy and reporting requirements for banks.
Visualize data quickly	Create a pie chart showing the market share of smartphones in the United States in 2024.
Understand the main point	Recap the findings of this research paper: [upload file]. Highlight the surprising or potentially controversial results, if they exist.
Stand out on socials	Craft an engaging LinkedIn post based on the content of [upload file].
Calculate the ROI	How much value will a $450,000 investment have after 5 years with an 8% return annually? Show your work.
Improve your writing	Rewrite my draft so it sounds more professional and less verbose [upload file].
Code faster	Write a python script to perform binary search.
Generate ideas	Suggest 10 compelling titles for this document: [upload file].
Jumpstart a draft using SharePoint agent[2]	Give me a minute elevator pitch about [topic] for my presentation with clients next week.
Get writing recommendations	Analyze the text in the following and make suggestions on how to improve it: [insert text]
Visualize a scene	Create an image with the running sneaker standing upright in a modern studio setting. The scene has a clean, minimalist design and the background includes a setting of simple minimalist gradients. [add an image]

[1]Image generation and file upload limits apply.
[2]Every SharePoint site comes with a "ready-made agent", automatically scoped to the content on that site. To get started, sign in to your SharePoint site with your work account. Open the agent chat pane. Select the dropdown arrow next to the current agent, you will see agents that have been approved for the site. Start asking questions about the site or selected document. Agents that access SharePoint content will be billed based on metered consumption.

Evaluation rubric

Use this ACRUE rubric as your guide to confidently compare AI tools. It breaks down each dimension with clear definitions and scoring tips, making it simple to evaluate Copilot alongside other solutions.

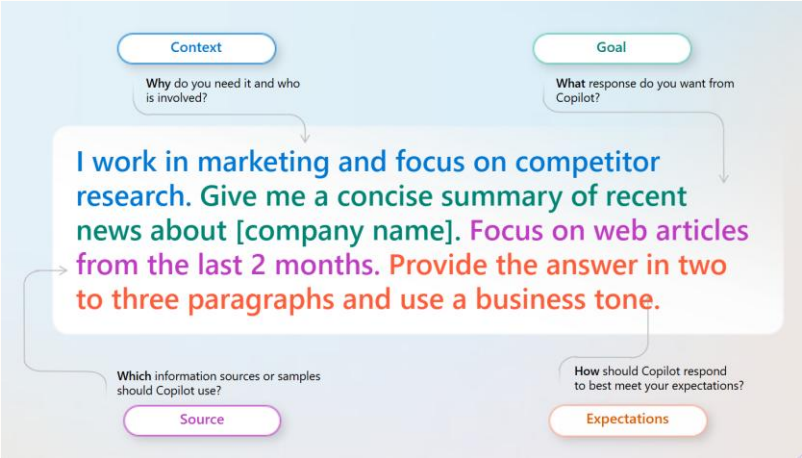
Evaluation Steps:

1. Begin by testing the sample prompts.
2. Examine and confirm the AI-generated answers. Check the sources and ensure the accuracy of your responses.
3. Try the test prompt on another AI chat platform.
4. Analyze the variations between the two responses across different aspects.
5. If you have feedback, use the thumbs up or down buttons, or inform your IT administrator.

Dimension	Definition	1 Very Poor	2 Poor	3 Acceptable	4 Good	5 Excellent	Microsoft 365 Copilot	Other
A - Accurate	*Are the facts correct?*	Contains clear factual errors	Mostly incorrect or misleading	Mostly correct with minor inaccuracies	Correct with minor nuance issues	Fully accurate and trustworthy		
C - Comprehensive	*Does it cover all important points?*	Misses major elements or is overly brief	Covers some points but lacks depth	Covers most relevant points	Covers nearly all key points with good depth	Thorough and complete		
R - Relevant	*Is it on-topic and aligned with the prompt?*	Off-topic or misinterprets the prompt	Partially relevant, some drift	Mostly relevant with slight drift	Clearly relevant with strong alignment	Directly addresses the prompt with precision		
U - Useful	*Does it help the user achieve their goal?*	Unhelpful or confusing	Somewhat helpful but unclear	Moderately helpful	Helpful and mostly actionable	Clearly actionable and insightful		
E - Exceptional	*Is it better than expected or uniquely valuable?*	Generic or uninspired	Slightly better than generic	Meets expectations	Adds value with clarity or creativity	Surpasses expectations with creativity or depth		

Prompt guidance

Prompts are how you have a conversation with Copilot. Use plain, clear language and provide context like you would with an assistant—prompts are like instructions you provide to Copilot. For the best responses, focus on these four key elements when phrasing your Copilot prompts: **context**, **goal**, **source**, and **expectations**.



Do's and don'ts

Most Copilot users generally receive the desired responses. However, as with any AI technology, there are occasions when the answer may not be what you expected. Artificial Intelligence is inherently unpredictable and does not always provide the anticipated outcomes. Get the most out of Copilot and avoid common pitfalls by learning what to do and what not to do when writing prompts:

Do's

- **Be clear and specific.** Provide specific instructions to Copilot, such as topic, purpose, tone, and required length.
- **Keep it conversational.** Give feedback to Copilot based on the quality of its responses to help the AI learn and match your preferences.
- **Give examples.** Use clear and specific keywords or phrases when asking Copilot to write a piece of text for you. This helps it generate more relevant and creative copy.
- **Ask for feedback.** Requesting feedback from Copilot helps it to understand your needs and preferences, and to provide you with more relevant, helpful responses.
- **Write legibly.** Use correct punctuation, capitalization, and grammar when writing prompts, as this will help the AI produce better quality text and responses.
- **Check for accuracy.** Occasionally, Copilot may make mistakes. Always check Copilot's responses for accuracy, grammar, and style, and watch out for irrelevant or inappropriate content.
- **Provide details.** Provide Copilot with contextual details to help it generate more accurate, consistent responses. For example, the genre, characters, and plot to a story.
- **Be polite.** Using kind and respectful language when chatting with Copilot helps foster collaboration and improves the AI's responsiveness and performance.

Don'ts

- **Be vague.** When prompting Copilot, avoid using vague language, and be as clear as possible to receive better-quality responses.
- **Request inappropriate or unethical content.** Copilot is not responsible for the content or the consequences of your writing. You should respect local laws, rules, and the rights of others.
- **Use slang, jargon, or informal language.** This may cause Copilot to give low-quality, inappropriate or unprofessional responses.
- **Give conflicting instructions.** Prompting Copilot to perform a task that includes multiple or conflicting pieces of information in the same request can confuse the AI and result in lower quality responses.
- **Interrupt or change topics abruptly.** This could disrupt Copilot's writing process. Always close or finish a task before starting a new one. When starting a new task, write "New task."

When using Copilot, think of it as having a conversation with a colleague. You wouldn't discuss a whole encyclopedia at once, right? Similarly, keep your document references concise and to the point for the best experience with Copilot.

Tips to get the most out of Copilot:

1. **Leverage your work data:** Copilot draws insights from your actual files and conversations, enabling it to deliver responses that align with your projects, priorities, and communication style.

2. **Use integration within Microsoft 365 apps:** Copilot is embedded in familiar apps like Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, and Teams, allowing you to create, edit, and analyze content seamlessly without switching between apps.

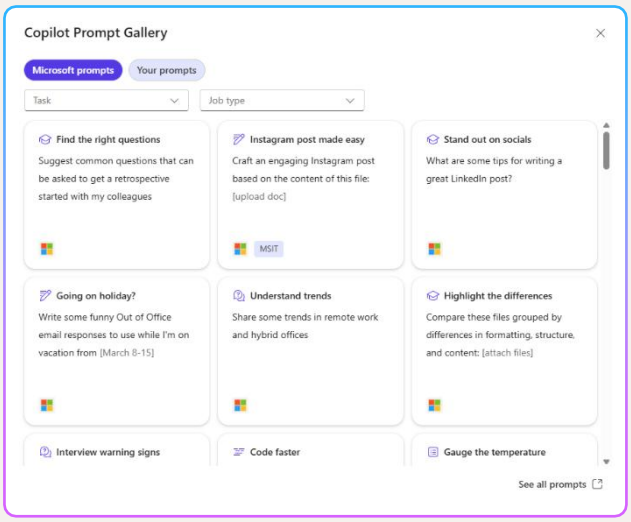
3. **Combine multiple tasks:** Copilot links information across different apps and responsibilities, offering a cohesive experience that saves time and maintains consistency throughout your work.

4. **Be clear and specific:** The more specific your instructions, the more accurate and relevant the results will be.

5. **Use iterative prompts:** Start broad, then refine.

Discover and share Copilot prompts

Copilot Prompt Gallery helps you find prompting inspiration so you can take greater advantage of Copilot in your daily work.

- Explore the curated selection of Copilot prompts
- Save your favorite prompts
- Share your favorite prompts with colleagues
- Find prompting inspiration from others

Access the Prompt Gallery in Copilot Chat by selecting the box with star icon next to the prompt box. Here, you'll see suggested Copilot prompts and your saved prompts.